

about their creation, though it is strongly suspected many spring into being during the Chrysalises of particularly tormented Dauntain. Some Kithain folklorists who study the oft-unpredictable phenomenon of Banal chimera believe that nocker Dauntain learn to use their Birthright to forge cold iron into Treasures.

Only two such Banal Treasures are known to changelings, though others are rumored to exist. Neither the Friar's Cross nor the Gray Sword have been seen in decades, but the High King offers a standing bounty on both. Should any individual or oathcircle succeed in locating and securing either item, King David has promised a royal boon upon the item's total destruction.

The Friar's Cross

Dating from the dark medieval period, the Friar's Cross is a large, ornate golden cross that hangs from a woven cord. Though once used as a symbol of faith and protection, the Friar's Cross has a history steeped in the destruction of changelings and the dissolution of faerie magic. Imbued with the Banality of repeated Undos, the Friar's Cross has become a corruptive device that eats the Glamour of whomever is unfortunate enough to wear it.

In the hands of the Undone, it is a potent weapon. The Cross links to the metaphysical emptiness where the changeling's fae soul once was, and becomes unstable in the presence of Kithain magic. Should the Undone be present near an Unleashing, the Friar's Cross explodes, dealing the Undone's permanent Banality rating in lethal damage to all creatures of the Dreaming within a 50-yard (45 meter) radius. In addition, it negates all faerie magic for one scene: Changelings are forced from their fae miens, chimera dissolve instantly, Treasures lose their Glamour, trods temporarily close, and balefires gutter to barely-glowing embers.

This often has the secondary effect of killing the Undone, which some might consider a mercy. The Friar's Cross itself remains intact, and may be used again.

The Gray Sword

The Gray Sword, though obviously chimerical, has no personality or adornment and appears as a mundane broadsword with a simple hilt and a flat, unmarked blade. Its history is murky at best. It is suspected that it was created by an Unseelie lord who sought to Undo a Seelie rival, but no name can be definitively linked to the sword's creation. The only fact that is known for certain is that, 20 years ago, it was reportedly in the hands of a Dauntain sidhe-hunter.

Each time the Gray Sword strikes, it applies a point of permanent Banality to its victim, in addition to its normal damage (Str + 3L). This Banality is transitory, and will fade at the rate of one point per day if the changeling survives the encounter. However, this Banality *can* push the changeling into forgetting her nature and, should it strike often enough to increase her Banality to 10, can Undo her entirely.

Thallain

Even creatures of myth and legend tell ghost stories. These stories speak of a fae race not seen since the Mythic Ages, twisted and terrifying, yet eerily similar to the Kithain. Where the children of the Tuatha provoke fear, anger, and sorrow in mortals to inspire them, shake them out of their complacency, and fill the world with Glamour, these boogymen terrorize and destroy without thought or care for the world's Dreamers. They are the ogres who kill and eat any who trespass on their bridges, the gremlins on the plane's wing sabotaging the engine, or the woman in white on the side of the road who murders any driver who offers her a ride. On the twilight of the Evanescence, the Kithain discovered that horror stories are all too real.

These creatures, collectively known as the Thallain, inhabited the Dreaming long before the Kithain or even the Tuatha de Danaan. Before the rise of humanity, the Mythic Realms would have been unrecognizable to modern fae. The Dreaming was a primordial world composed of raw savagery and base instinct. Higher ideals weren't merely unheard of; they didn't yet even exist. Life was brutal and short. Hunting, eating, mating, and surviving, all by any means necessary, were the height of aspiration. Emerging from these ancient dreams were the Fomorians.

The Fomorians birthed the Thallain in their image to be the inheritors of their nascent Dream. The Thallain served their masters well, fostering their visceral existence. They took the best kills for themselves, leaving naught but an arduous hunt for all others. Ravenous hunger followed in their wake as the Thallain gorged themselves. They provoked insatiable lust, rendering all passion into wanton madness. They rained death at random, sundering life into futility. The Thallain reveled in their duty.

All things must end, and so too did the dominance of the Fomorians. For eons mere beasts evolved and went extinct, until a spark finally flickered in one otherwise insignificant species. Humans didn't simply survive, they thrived and spread to all corners of the world thanks to their unique abilities to love, laugh, rage, mourn, and fear for individuals other than themselves. New inhabitants of the Dreaming, the Tuatha de Danaan, followed in humanity's footsteps, fanning the flames of their creative embers wherever they traveled together.

As humans, Tuatha, and their children, the Kithain, rose in power, the Fomorian dominance waned. They found the Dreaming inexorably changing as the Fomorian Dream was slowly snuffed out. The Fomorians and Thallain waged war against the Tuatha and Kithain to protect the very fabric of reality as they knew it, in a conflict known as the Tesseract, the War of Trees. Casualties were massive on both sides, but one by one, the Fomorian courts fell. In the end, the Tuatha stood victorious while the Fomorians were eternally imprisoned. The Thallain and their Dark-kin allies were banished to the Nightmare Realms, their return precluded by the Silver Ban.

Ages passed, the Tuatha de Danaan departed for realms unknown, and the Kithain gradually forgot their relationship